

RATAN TATA
70, INDUSTRIALIST (1)

GLOBAL ICON

BECAUSE he makes us proud to be Indian. Because he is the only big billionaire who could understand the hopes of little India. Because his Rs 1-lakh Nano got a reception worthy of a rockstar and unleashed the dreams of a billion Indians. Because with over half or \$25 billion of its revenues from overseas businesses, Tata Sons embodies the idea of a global Indian empire. Because after acquiring Corus for Rs 52,000 crore, he has set his sights on the Jaguar and the Land Rover. Because after conquering the roads, he wants to make military jets. Because he has taken group revenues from \$29 billion to \$50 billion in the last year. Because the group's post-tax profits will double to touch Rs 20,000 crore within a year. Because he is investing over \$35 billion across businesses in the next three years. Because his group's market capitalisation exceeds \$65 billion. Because when Orient-Express Hotels turned up their nose at Tata Sons' takeover bid, all of India saw it as a racial slur. Because success for him is not a personal quest for wealth, with 79 per cent of Tata Sons owned by public trusts and group companies.

UNDERSTATEMENT WHILE LAUNCHING THE NANO: "A promise is a promise."

COOL FRIENDS: Tito and Tango, his German Shepherds.

DOES NOT BRAG ABOUT: How the group spent Rs 557 crore last year on social initiatives.

IDEA OF A TIME

OFF: Likes to be free and anonymous in New York or Sao Paulo.

WEEKENDS ARE AT: Alibaug by the sea.

LITTLE KNOWN FACT: Has been caught playing practical pranks on fellow directors at meetings.

WILL ALWAYS STOP: To check out latest car models.

AT LAST COUNT, RATAN TATA AND NANO WERE FEATURED ON THE COVERS OF 25 MAGAZINES WORLDWIDE.